

Two

BEHOLD, THE LAMB!

Read John 1:19–51;
other references as given.

The prologue to John's gospel (1:1–18) begins with an introduction of Jesus as the Word of God and concludes with a summary statement that Jesus Christ is the declaration of God (John 1:18).

Jesus Christ is God! He existed before time began, and He is the creator of all things (John 1:1–3). Jesus came to those He created, but His own people did not accept Him (John 1:10–11). **But as many as received Him, to them He gave the right to become children of God** (John 1:12).

This second lesson focuses on (1) John the Baptist's testimony of Jesus as the Christ, and (2) the initial call of two of John's followers to be Jesus' original disciples. In John's interaction with religious leaders, you will see a profound example of true humility.

Before you begin, please ask God to reveal Himself through His Word and to give you grace to accept the truths you will be learning.

1. Andrew Murray, the late South African pastor and writer, said, "Humility is not a Christian grace like the other graces. It is the foundation of all Christian graces."
 - a. What do you think are characteristics of a truly humble person?



Zip-It Principle

Group participants should agree to disagree, but they should never be disagreeable.

ADD GROUP
INSIGHTS BELOW

- b. **God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble** (James 4:6). In what areas of your life do you continue to see pride manifesting itself?

2. John the Baptist's ministry was so powerful that the Jewish religious leaders sent representatives to question him about his true identity (John 1:19-27).

- a. When the Jewish priests and Levites questioned John, what specific things did he say to point them to Christ rather than draw attention to himself (John 1:19-27)?

- b. Elijah was an Old Testament prophet who lived hundreds of years earlier. Why did the Jewish priests and Levites ask John if he was Elijah (John 1:21; Malachi 4:4-6; Matthew 11:7-14)?

- c. Since Jesus said John the Baptist **is Elijah who is to**

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come (Matthew 11:11-15), why did John deny it (John 1:21)?

3. In your own words, identify an important spiritual truth from each of the following verses to help you become a more humble person.

a. Psalm 24:1. _____

b. Mark 10:44-45. _____

c. John 15:5. _____

d. 1 Corinthians 4:7. _____

e. 2 Corinthians 10:17. _____

f. James 4:10. _____

4. John the Baptist called Jesus **the Lamb of God** (John 1:29, 36), an obvious reference to the Passover lamb that God instructed the Israelites to sacrifice on the night they left Egypt (Exodus 12).

- a. What happened at the time of the original Passover observance when the Jews placed the lamb's blood on the doorposts and the lintels (main support piece over the doors) of their homes (Exodus 12:1-7, 21-23)?



Use the side margins to write spiritual insights from other people in your group. Add the person's name and the date to help you remember in the future.

ADDITIONAL
INSIGHTS

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- b. The Passover lamb had to be **without blemish** (Exodus 12:5; NIV: "without defect"), meaning the sacrificed animal must be free of physical defects. No maimed, injured, or disfigured animal was an acceptable sacrifice to God. What important statement did the writer of Hebrews include in Hebrews 9:14 that identified Christ's sacrifice on the cross with the Old Testament Passover lamb and John the Baptist's statement that Jesus was the Lamb of God?
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5. In his natural state, man is unacceptable to a holy God because he is not **without blemish** (without sin, Romans 3:10-12). There is nothing you can do (good works, religious acts, gifts of charity, etc.) to abrogate or nullify your sinful condition. Do you believe you are a sinner incapable of saving yourself from eternal judgment by your own good religious or moral efforts? If you would like to know how you can be saved from God's judgment, turn to "The Final Exam" at the back of this book.
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6. John's statement **I did not know Him** is mentioned twice to emphasize that the baptizer did not originally comprehend Jesus' true identity (John 1:31, 33). Who did John eventually understand Jesus to be (John 1:29-34)?
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7. Jesus called two of John's followers to be His original disciples (John 1:35-40). When Andrew and an unnamed individual (likely the apostle John) began to follow Jesus, He turned and said, **What do you seek?** (John 1:38; NIV: "What

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do you want?"). Some Bible commentators understand Jesus' question to mean "What are you really seeking in a relationship with me?"

- a. What types of things do people desire from God (Mark 3:2; Luke 11:29; John 6:26–27)?

- b. What did the God-fearing Greeks ask Philip (John 12:20–21)?

- c. Honestly evaluate your relationship with God. What is the *main* thing you are seeking from a relationship with Him?

8. a. Whom did Andrew tell his brother Peter he had found (John 1:41)?

- b. Whom did Philip tell Nathaniel he had found (John 1:45)?

- c. Whom did Nathaniel believe Jesus to be (John 1:49)?



When the leader asks the study questions, the group discussion will be more likely to stay on track.

ADDITIONAL
INSIGHTS

9. When Jesus said to Nathaniel **Behold, an Israelite indeed, in whom is no deceit!** (John 1:47), He used a play on words in order to contrast Nathaniel's honorable character to the Old Testament patriarch Jacob (also known as Israel), who was a deceiver. Jacob had two powerful encounters with God—the first being a dream of angels ascending and descending on a ladder to and from heaven (Genesis 28:10–17). Jesus' use of this illustration would have been very familiar to Nathaniel. Carefully study Genesis 28:10–17 and John 1:50–51. What important addition does Jesus make to Jacob's original dream, and what do you think it signifies?

10. List ten words or phrases (and their corresponding verse references) used to describe Jesus in John 1.
